

# **GUIDELINES FOR THE PREPARATION OF REPORTS BY MEMBER STATES ON THE APPLICATION OF THE 1960 CONVENTION AND RECOMMENDATION AGAINST DISCRIMINATION IN EDUCATION**

## **Preparation of the 11th Consultation**

### **Combating discrimination in education**

Eleventh consultation of Member States on the application of the Convention and the Recommendation against Discrimination in Education (1960) (2024-2025)

## **GUIDELINES FOR THE PREPARATION OF REPORTS BY MEMBER STATES ON THE APPLICATION OF THE 1960 CONVENTION AND RECOMMENDATION AGAINST DISCRIMINATION IN EDUCATION**

### **1. Introduction**

The Convention against Discrimination in Education (“the Convention”) and the Recommendation against Discrimination in Education (“the Recommendation”), adopted by UNESCO’s General Conference in 1960, are aligned with UNESCO’s constitutional mandate to “advance the ideal of equality of educational opportunities without regard to race, sex or any distinctions, economic or social”. The Convention is the first legally binding international instrument focused on the **right to education** and the only one exclusively dedicated to it.

The right to education is one of the key principles underpinning the Education 2030 agenda and Sustainable Development Goal 4 (SDG4) adopted by the international community in 2015. SDG 4 seeks to ensure the full enjoyment of the right to education as fundamental to achieving sustainable development. Its scope captures the multidimensional nature of the right to education.

Representing a powerful tool to advance SDG 4 by ensuring effective articulation between normative and operational work, the Convention has been recognized as a cornerstone of Education 2030 agenda.

The present Guidelines are intended to assist Member States in the preparation of country reports on the implementation of the Convention and the Recommendation in the context of the 11th consultation.

### **2. Scope of the Consultation**

Considering the Education 2030 agenda, the monitoring of the Convention and the Recommendation is of crucial importance to ensure an education that is truly inclusive for all and to counter persistent inequalities in access, participation and learning outcomes at all levels, particularly for the most vulnerable groups. This is particularly true under the current context in which countries are making efforts to recover from the learning disruption caused by the COVID-19 pandemic. Concrete measures taken by countries in accordance with their legal obligations under these instruments contribute to implementing the Education 2030 agenda.

As the scope and content of the legal obligations under the right to education are aligned with the 10 targets of SDG 4, efforts are being made to ensure that the components of the targets are included in the guidelines and that these guidelines serve as a valuable contribution to monitoring progress towards SDG 4 targets.

Beyond SDG 4, the Convention is also closely aligned with the normative content on the right to education of other international human rights instruments such as the International Covenant on Economic, Social and Cultural Rights (1966), Convention on the Elimination of All Forms of

Discrimination against Women (1979), the Convention on the Rights of the Child (1989) and the Convention on the Rights of Persons with Disabilities (2006).

In addition, this Consultation is an opportunity to inform the ongoing **UNESCO Initiative on the Evolving Right to Education within a lifelong learning perspective**<sup>1</sup> (launched in December 2021). The Initiative investigates how the right to education could be reinforced placing it within a lifelong learning perspective and in light of the new demands being placed on education. This Initiative builds on the **Report from the International Commission on the Futures of Education**<sup>2</sup>, which suggests to broaden our understanding of the right to education to clearly apply it to all ages and across all times and spaces. The initiative is also in-line with the **Vision Statement of the United Nations Secretary General on Transforming Education**<sup>3</sup>, and the **Report on the 2022 Transforming Education Summit**<sup>4</sup> which call for the transformation of education systems to 'include everyone, regardless of circumstance, context or background'. The Initiative on the Evolving Right to Education aims to open a collaborative and participatory discussion about the international framework to ensure the effective enforcement of the right to education and learning throughout life for all. Finally, the Initiative builds on recent inter-governmental dialogues, including the Marrakech Framework for Action for Adult Learning and Education<sup>5</sup> and the Tashkent Declaration on Early Childhood Care and Education.<sup>6</sup>

It is also important to note that previous consultations on the Convention and Recommendation revealed that countries now understand the right to education in an extended manner. The 11th consultation builds on the findings of the previous national reports to include various areas that have direct repercussions on the right to education such as, for instance, digital learning, climate considerations, lifelong learning entitlement, and the role of non-state actors in education.

### 3. Reporting obligations

There are differences in the legal nature of the obligations under the Convention, as distinguished from those under the Recommendation. The Convention has binding force and the States Parties are under the obligation to incorporate its provisions into their domestic frameworks. The Recommendation, non-binding in nature, has political and moral force. Its adoption sought to take into account the difficulties that certain States might experience in ratifying the Convention, in particular with respect to their federal structure.

Bearing in mind the differences in legal scope inherent to the nature of these two categories of instruments, the content of the Recommendation is identical to that of the Convention. Member States are expected to give effect to it in national legislation and education policies.

The reporting obligation under the provisions of Article VII of the Convention and of the Recommendation is the same. Article VIII of UNESCO's Constitution states that "*Each Member State shall submit to the Organization, at such times and in such manner as shall be determined by the General Conference, reports on the laws, regulations and statistics relating to its educational, scientific and cultural institutions and activities, and on the action taken upon the recommendations and conventions referred to in Article IV, paragraph 4*". Therefore, even if a country is not a State Party to the Convention, it needs to submit a report on the implementation of the Recommendation, which means that **all UNESCO Member States are expected to submit a national report** on the implementation of these instruments in the context of monitoring consultations.

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<sup>1</sup> <https://www.unesco.org/en/right-education/evolving>

<sup>2</sup> <https://unesdoc.unesco.org/ark:/48223/pf0000379707>

<sup>3</sup> [https://www.un.org/sites/un2.un.org/files/2022/09/sg\\_vision\\_statement\\_on\\_transforming\\_education.pdf](https://www.un.org/sites/un2.un.org/files/2022/09/sg_vision_statement_on_transforming_education.pdf)

<sup>4</sup> [https://www.un.org/sites/un2.un.org/files/report\\_on\\_the\\_2022\\_transforming\\_education\\_summit.pdf](https://www.un.org/sites/un2.un.org/files/report_on_the_2022_transforming_education_summit.pdf)

<sup>5</sup> [Marrakech Framework for Action | Institute for Lifelong Learning \(unesco.org\)](https://www.unesco.org/en/marrakech-framework-for-action)

<sup>6</sup> [Tashkent-declaration-ecce-2022.pdf \(unesco.org\)](https://www.unesco.org/en/tashkent-declaration-ecce-2022)

#### 4. Participation in consultations

The reporting period for the 11th consultation on the implementation of the Convention and the Recommendation covers four years (2021-2024).

The Futures of Education Report calls for a new social contract for education, which requires to understand education as a common good and a shared societal endeavour. To ensure this, extensive consultations involving a broad range of stakeholders is needed. The reporting process therefore needs to be **participatory**. This includes ensuring cooperation between ministries of education and other ministries dealing with aspects of the right to education as well as consulting social partners and **civil society organizations** and other relevant bodies.

The preparation of national reports provides a **good opportunity** for Member States to assess the implementation of the right to education in their country, identify specific challenges, build constructive dialogue with other actors involved in this field and share good practices.

In the preparation of reports, Member States are encouraged to provide **substantive and relevant information in a concise manner**. In addition to a description of the constitutional, legislative, administrative, and policy framework established for the implementation of the provisions guaranteed by the instruments, the information supplied by Member States should demonstrate how legal norms and practices comply with the Convention and the Recommendation.

Relevant information supplied for other reporting instances may be reproduced or referred to with precise indication as to its retrieval. Similarly, hyperlinks to any useful documents or relevant legal and policy texts are most welcome and texts can also be added in the annex.

Country reports submitted for previous consultations can be found on the **Observatory on the right to education**<sup>7</sup> in the monitoring section of the country profile. The information provided in the reports are valuable both for the Observatory on the right to education as well as for **HerAtlas**<sup>8</sup>, the online monitoring tool for girls' and women's right to education. Information and data regarding countries' education systems are also available through the UNESCO Institute for Statistics database<sup>9</sup>. Beyond monitoring purposes, the consultation findings and reports inform broader work - serving for knowledge generation, advocacy, and technical cooperation.

#### 5. Modalities and structure

The Guidelines are structured around three chapters:

- The **first chapter** covers general information on adherence to the Convention.
- The **second chapter** aims to gather information on the implementation of the Convention and Recommendation in the context of Sustainable Development Goal 4. As the most extensive part of the Guidelines, this chapter covers: inclusion and non-discrimination in education (section 1), all levels and forms of education (section 2), quality education provision and learning environment (section 3) and finally, strengthening governance systems (section 4).
- The **third chapter** seeks to obtain information on the methods used to draw the attention of the various authorities in the country to the instruments.

With a view to simplify the Guidelines while providing necessary substantive information to assist Member States in the preparation of responses, through a participatory process, **two types of guidance** are provided:

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<sup>7</sup> <http://www.unesco.org/education/edurights/index.php?action=home&lng=en>

<sup>8</sup> <https://en.unesco.org/education/girls-women-rights>

<sup>9</sup> [UIS Statistics \(unesco.org\)](https://uis.unesco.org)

- (1) Open-ended and closed-ended questions to be directly filled in by Member States. Please note that multiple answers may be provided where relevant.
- (2) Additional information aimed at guiding Members States to structure and detail their responses to the open-ended questions (including remarks on how to respond efficiently to the questions raised). These elements are presented in italics.

## GENERAL INFORMATION:

Country name: Turkmenistan

Organization or entity responsible for the preparation of the report: Ministry of Education of Turkmenistan

Name of contact person: Gulnabat Gurdova, Head of the International Relations Department

Email and telephone number of contact person: [gulnabatgurdova.tsiem@gmail.com](mailto:gulnabatgurdova.tsiem@gmail.com)

## I. Ratification and applicability of the Convention against Discrimination in Education<sup>10</sup>

- Is your country a State Party to the Convention?

☒ Yes

☐ No: Does your country plan to ratify this instrument?

☐ Yes: Please indicate the stage of ratification process reached by your country and whether assistance is needed:

☐ There is interest but no concrete action has been taken

☐ The ratification process has been initiated

☐ The ratification process is close to completion

- Please briefly explain the steps that have been taken and timeline when relevant, any difficulties encountered (legal, institutional, political or practical) in completing the ratification process. And how UNESCO can assist:

☐ No, not considering ratification. Please explain why:

- Is the Convention directly applicable in your country's domestic law?

☒ Yes ☐ No

- Have courts, tribunals and/or administrative authorities adjudicated on issues or violations regarding the right to education?<sup>11</sup>

☒ No

<sup>10</sup> <https://www.unesco.org/en/legal-affairs/convention-against-discrimination-education>

<sup>11</sup> Judicial mechanisms play an important role in enforcing the right to education by ensuring legal accountability and therefore contributing to the practical realization of the right to education.

☐ Yes: Have the provisions of the Convention been invoked?

☐ Yes ☐ No

- Please cite the case law and jurisprudence.

*Information could also be given about the judicial, administrative and other competent authorities having jurisdiction with respect to the right to education.*

The system of bodies within the Prosecutor's Office in Turkmenistan carries out general prosecutorial oversight over the implementation of the right to education. Regarding the precedents of applying to the court, it is necessary to find out from the Supreme Court of Turkmenistan.

## II. Information on the implementation of the Convention or Recommendation in the context of Sustainable Development Goal 4 (SDG4)

### 1. Towards an inclusive non-discriminatory education system

*For reference: This section relates to the main purpose of the Convention/Recommendation that is to underscore the state obligation to proscribe any form of discrimination in education while promoting equality of educational opportunity as laid out in Articles/Paragraphs 1(1), 2 and 3 of the Convention/Recommendation.*

*It further corresponds to the overall aspiration of SDG4 which aims to “ensure inclusive and equitable quality education and promote lifelong learning opportunities for all” by 2030. While it covers all the SDG4 targets, it also specifically covers SDG target 4.5.<sup>12</sup>*

- Please indicate whether the rights and principles laid out in the Convention/Recommendation informed the elaboration of the education legal and/or policy framework:

☐ Yes ☐ No

- If yes, please provide reference:

The Constitution of Turkmenistan: <https://minjust.gov.tm/ru/hukuk/merkezi>

The Law of Turkmenistan On Education: <https://minjust.gov.tm/ru/hukuk/merkezi>

#### 1.1 Non-discrimination and equality in education

- Please indicate measures adopted to both prevent and eliminate discrimination in education within the meaning of the Convention/Recommendation<sup>13</sup>, and ensure equal access to all levels and types of education (please tick all that apply):

<sup>12</sup> Which calls on states to “eliminate gender disparities in education and ensure equal access to all levels of education and vocational training for the vulnerable, including persons with disabilities, indigenous peoples and children in vulnerable situations”.

<sup>13</sup> See: Article/Paragraph 1(1).

*For reference: This notably is covered under SDG target 4.1 and partly target 4.b<sup>14</sup>*

☐ Legal texts<sup>15</sup> prohibit discrimination and guarantee equal access to education: (The Law of Turkmenistan On Education, Article 4) (Gazette of the Milli Gengesh of Turkmenistan, 2021, No. 2-3, Article 43)

☐ In pre-primary education (including early learning and care)

☐ In primary education

☐ In secondary education

☐ In technical and vocational education and training

☐ In higher education

☐ In adult education and alternative learning

- Please indicate the relevant legal provisions:

The Constitution of Turkmenistan: <https://minjust.gov.tm/ru/hukuk/merkezi>

The Law of Turkmenistan On Education: <https://minjust.gov.tm/ru/hukuk/merkezi>

- Please list the prohibited grounds of discrimination in education as laid out in legal texts:

ARTICLE No. 55 of the Constitution of Turkmenistan: Everyone has the right to education. General secondary education is compulsory, and everyone has the right to receive it in public educational institutions for free. The State ensures that vocational education is accessible to everyone in accordance with their abilities. The implementation of paid educational activities is allowed on the grounds and in accordance with the procedure established by law. Mandatory State educational standards are established for all educational institutions.

Article 4. The Law of Turkmenistan;  
“On Education”;: 1. Citizens of Turkmenistan are guaranteed the opportunity to receive education regardless of nationality, skin color, gender, origin, property and official status, place of residence, language, attitude to religion, political beliefs or other circumstances, as well as age and health status. Based on gender, age and health status, the Cabinet of Ministers of Turkmenistan may establish restrictions on obtaining education in certain professions of workers, specialties and areas of training, as well as forms of education.

2. The State provides citizens of Turkmenistan with the right to education by creating an education system and appropriate socio-economic conditions for education. 3. The State guarantees citizens of Turkmenistan to receive compulsory and free general secondary education, and also provides, in accordance with their abilities, affordable vocational education in state educational institutions. 4. In order to realize the right to education of citizens of Turkmenistan in need of social support, the State shall bear the costs of their maintenance during the period of their education. The categories of

<sup>14</sup> Which calls on states to “substantially expand globally the number of scholarships available [...] for enrolment in higher education, including vocational training and information and communications technology, technical, engineering and scientific programmes”.

<sup>15</sup> Constitution, laws, decrees, regulations, circulars, etc.

citizens to whom 4 state social support is provided, the procedure and amount of its provision are established by the legislation of Turkmenistan.

5. The State creates conditions for citizens of Turkmenistan with disabilities, that is, those with disabilities in physical and (or) mental development, to receive education in general educational institutions (inclusive education). For citizens of Turkmenistan who cannot attend general educational institutions due to health reasons, special educational institutions are being created to provide them with education based on special pedagogical approaches, correction of developmental disorders and social adaptation.

6. The State provides assistance in obtaining education for citizens of Turkmenistan who have shown a high level of intellectual development and creative abilities in a certain field of educational and research activities, scientific, technical and artistic creativity, physical culture and sports, including by providing them with special state scholarships, including scholarships for study in foreign countries. The criteria and procedure for granting special state scholarships are established by the Cabinet of Ministers of Turkmenistan. «Analysis of the Law of Turkmenistan "On Education" and its impact on the development of the educational system»

**\*\*July version text is as per below\*\***

**Constitution of Turkmenistan** (new edition) (With amendments and additions introduced by the Constitutional Laws of Turkmenistan dated 09.10.2017 No. 617-V, 25.09.2020 No. 297-VI and 21.01.2023 No. 531-VI)

**Article 55.** Every person has the right to education. General secondary education is compulsory, every person has the right to receive it in state educational institutions free of charge. The state ensures the availability of vocational education for every person in accordance with his or her abilities. The implementation of paid educational activities is permitted on the grounds and in the manner established by law. Mandatory state educational standards are established for all educational institutions.

**Article 40.** Family, motherhood, fatherhood and childhood are under the protection of the state. A man and a woman upon reaching marriageable age have the right to enter into marriage and start a family by mutual consent. Spouses are equal in family relations. Parents or persons replacing them have the right and are obliged to raise children, care for their health, development, education, prepare them for work, instill in them a culture of respect for laws, historical and national traditions. Adult children are obliged to care for their parents and provide them with assistance. The state creates conditions for the exercise of the rights and freedoms of young people and promotes their comprehensive development.

2. The Law of Turkmenistan On Education (new edition) (Bulletin of the Milli Gengesha of Turkmenistan, 2021, No. 2-3, Art. 43) (As amended by the Laws of Turkmenistan dated March 16, 2023 No. 541-VI and June 3, 2023 No. 34-VII) The Law of Turkmenistan "On Education", adopted on May 4, 2013 (Bulletin of the Mejlis of Turkmenistan, 2013, No. 2, Art. 21; 2014, No. 4, Art. 159; 2017, No. 1, Art. 36; 2018, No. 2, Art. 55; 2020, No. 3, Art. 50)

Article 4. State guarantees of the rights of citizens of Turkmenistan in the field of education 1. Citizens of Turkmenistan are guaranteed the opportunity to receive an education regardless of nationality, skin color, gender, origin, property and official status, place of residence, language, attitude to religion, political beliefs or other circumstances, as well as age and health. Based on gender, age and health, the Cabinet of Ministers of Turkmenistan may establish restrictions on obtaining an education in certain professions of workers, specialties and areas of training, as well as forms of education. 2. The state ensures the citizens of Turkmenistan the right to education by creating an education system and appropriate socio-economic conditions for obtaining an education. 3. The state guarantees citizens of Turkmenistan compulsory and free general



secondary education, and also provides, in accordance with their abilities, accessible vocational education in state educational institutions. 4. In order to implement the right to education of citizens of Turkmenistan in need of social support, the state bears the costs of their maintenance during the period of their education. The categories of citizens 4 who are provided with state social support, the procedure and amount of its provision are established by the legislation of Turkmenistan. 5. The state creates conditions for citizens of Turkmenistan with disabilities, that is, those with physical and (or) mental developmental disabilities, to obtain an education in general educational institutions (inclusive education). For citizens of Turkmenistan who, due to health reasons, cannot attend general educational institutions, special educational institutions are created to obtain an education based on special pedagogical approaches, correction of developmental disabilities and social adaptation. 6. The state provides assistance in obtaining an education for citizens of Turkmenistan who have demonstrated a high level of intellectual development and creative abilities in a certain area of educational and research activities, scientific, technical and artistic creativity, physical education and sports, including through the provision of special state scholarships, including scholarships for study in foreign countries. The criteria and procedure for providing special state scholarships are established by the Cabinet of Ministers of Turkmenistan. **\*\*Analysis of the Law of Turkmenistan "On Education" and its impact on the development of the educational system\*\***

*Turkmenistan's Law on Education, which has been amended and supplemented in recent years, underlines the country's commitment to ensuring broad access to educational resources for all segments of the population. Article 4 of this law highlights several key aspects that deserve special attention:*

*1. State guarantees of the right to education: The legislation guarantees the opportunity to receive education to every citizen regardless of their origin, gender, age, health status and other social or economic factors. This confirms Turkmenistan's commitment to the principles of equality and inclusiveness. in the educational sphere.*

*2. Compulsory and free general secondary education: Ensuring free access to general secondary education is a fundamental element that contributes to raising the educational level of the population and training qualified personnel.*

*3. Vocational education based on abilities: The state ensures access to vocational education based on the abilities of each individual, which promotes the development of specialized skills and preparation for in-demand professions.*

*4. Social support in education: Particular attention is paid to social support for students in need of assistance, including payment for their maintenance during their studies, which indicates the social orientation of state policy.*

*5. Inclusive education: The Law places particular emphasis on creating conditions for the education of persons with disabilities, ensuring their access to educational resources and specialized institutions.*

*6. Support for talented youth: The state provides support to students who demonstrate high achievements in studies, science and art by providing special scholarships, including*

*opportunities to study abroad.*

*These provisions of the Law "On Education" play an important role in the formation of a modern, dynamic and fair educational system in Turkmenistan, aimed at maximizing the potential of each citizen.*

☐ Policies, programmes and initiatives aim to prohibit and prevent discrimination and ensure equal access to education

- ☐ In pre-primary education (including early learning and care)
- ☐ In primary education
- ☐ In secondary education
- ☐ In technical and vocational education and training
- ☐ In higher education
- ☐ In adult education and alternative learning

- Please provide details:

The Constitution of Turkmenistan: <https://minjust.gov.tm/ru/hukuk/merkezi>

The Law of Turkmenistan On Education: <https://minjust.gov.tm/ru/hukuk/merkezi>

Resolution of the President of Turkmenistan on approval of the Regulations on State vocational educational institutions 10/22/2021

In order to strengthen the legal basis of youth policy and more fully realize the multifaceted potential of youth, a new version of the Law "On State Youth Policy" was adopted. To implement legislative rights, the following have been approved: The State Program in the field of State youth policy of Turkmenistan for 2021-2025; in June this year, the Strategy for International Cooperation of Youth of Turkmenistan for 2023-2030 was adopted. The purpose of these documents is to ensure more active participation of young people in a multilateral dialogue with their foreign peers in cultural, economic, scientific, educational, sports and other fields.

In Turkmenistan, special attention is paid to active cooperation with the structure of the United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization – UNESCO. This partnership initiative has already involved higher educational institutions of Turkmenistan in its circle. UNESCO chairs have been opened at the Turkmen State University named after Magtymguly and the Turkmen State Pedagogical Institute named after Seyitnazar Seydi. UNESCO clubs are successfully functioning, and six secondary educational institutions are included in the UNESCO Associated Schools network. The Magtymguly Youth Organization of Turkmenistan has been accepted as an official member of the UNESCO Global Youth Community (GYC).

☐ Combatting discrimination in terms of curriculum:

- ☐ In pre-primary education (including early learning and care)
- ☐ In primary education

- ☐ In secondary education
- ☐ In technical and vocational education and training
- ☐ In higher education
- ☐ In adult education and alternative learning

- Please provide details:

The Law of Turkmenistan On Education: <https://minjust.gov.tm/ru/hukuk/merkezi>  
Article 8. Educational programs

1. An educational program is a set of the content of training, its scope and time of implementation, planned learning outcomes, which is presented in the form of a curriculum, a calendar curriculum, curricula in subjects (cycles, modules, courses), other components, as well as evaluation and methodological materials.
2. In Turkmenistan, educational programs are divided into: 1) general education; 2) professional.
3. General education programs are aimed at acquiring knowledge, skills, and competencies that contribute to the formation of a general culture of personality, its adaptation to life in society, continuing education at the subsequent level of general secondary education, and creating conditions for an informed choice of professional educational programs. General education programs include: 1) pre-school education; 2) primary education; 3) basic secondary education; 4) full secondary education; 5) extracurricular and additional education of students.
4. Professional educational programs are aimed at acquiring knowledge, skills, and competencies that allow you to conduct professional activities in a certain field and (or) perform work in a specific worker; s profession or specialty (field of training), as well as to consistently improve professional qualifications. Professional educational programs include: 1) vocational education; 2) secondary vocational education; 3)

higher vocational education; 4) postgraduate vocational education; 5) professional development and retraining of personnel.

5. The regulatory deadlines for the development of educational programs in educational institutions are determined by this Law, as well as the regulations on educational institutions of appropriate types and forms of ownership or educational standards.

Article 9. The levels of education of the relevant state

1. The classification of education levels in Turkmenistan is based on the UNESCO International Standard Classification of Education and is carried out in accordance with the content of educational programs, based on their complexity, acquired knowledge and skills, established 8 requirements for previous educational programs, conditions of organization and methods of providing educational services.
2. According to general education programs, the following levels of education are established: 1) the level of pre-school education; 2) the levels of general secondary education: a) primary education; b) basic secondary education; c) complete secondary education.
3. According to professional educational programs, the following levels of education are established: 1) the level of vocational education; 2) the level of secondary vocational education; 3) the levels of higher professional education: a) specialist program; b) bachelors' program; c) master's program; 4) the level of postgraduate vocational education.

Article 10. General requirements for the content and quality of education

1. The content of education should provide: 1) the formation of students' general and professional culture that meets the international level; 2) the integration of personality into national and world culture; 3) the formation of high spiritual and

moral qualities of personality; 4) the development of the abilities of each person.

2. The content of education should meet the goals of achieving national consolidation of the Turkmen people, ensuring civil, interethnic and interfaith peace and harmony in Turkmenistan, take into account the diversity of worldview approaches, and promote the realization of the right of students to choose and freely express their opinions and beliefs.

3. The content of education in an educational institution is determined by educational programs, students of the requirements that ensure the achievement of the relevant state educational standards.

4. High-quality education should ensure the development of skills, values, attitudes and knowledge that enable a person to lead a healthy and fulfilling life, make informed decisions and solve national and global problems.

5. The quality of education is ensured: 1) the availability of innovative teaching methods and modern educational programs that meet the needs and abilities of students; 2) motivated by teaching by qualified teachers, trained workers using modern pedagogical approaches and relying on appropriate information and communication technologies; 3) the availability and improvement of systems and

methods for evaluating quality education, including the assessment of learning tools and processes, as well as the availability of mechanisms to assess the results achieved.

#### Article 11. Forms of education and forms of education

1. Taking into account the needs and capabilities of students, the development of educational programs can take place through such forms of education as education in an educational institution, self-education, and externship.

2. Uniform state educational standards apply to all forms of education within the framework of a general education program or a professional educational program.

3. Educational institutions use such forms of education as full-time (full-time, on-the-job), part-time (on-the-job with off-the-job training) and part-time (on-the-job).

4. Full-time (full-time) education is established for general education programs.

5. Lists of professions of workers, areas of training and specialties in which full-time and part-time education is not provided are established by the Cabinet of Ministers of Turkmenistan.

6. The conditions for obtaining education through self-education and externship are determined by the legislation of Turkmenistan.

☐ Other measures adopted to both prevent and eliminate discrimination in education and ensure equal access to all levels and types of education:

<https://www.unicef.org/turkmenistan/ru/%D0%9F%D1%80%D0%B5%D1%81%D1%81-%D1%80%D0%B5%D0%BB%D0%B8%D0%B7%D1%8B/%D0%B2%D0%BE-%D0%B2%D1%81%D0%B5%D0%BC%D0%B8%D1%80%D0%BD%D1%8B%D0%B9-%D0%B4%D0%B5%D0%BD%D1%8C-%D1%80%D0%B5%D0%B1%D0%B5%D0%BD%D0%BA%D0%B0-%D0%B7%D0%B0%D0%BF%D1%83%D1%89%D0%B5%D0%BD-%D1%81%D0%B8%D0%BD%D1%82%D0%B5%D0%B7%D0%B0%D1%82%D0%BE%D1%80-%D1%80%D0%B5%D1%87%D0%B8-%D0%BD%D0%B0-%D1%82%D1%83%D1%80%D0%BA%D0%BC%D0%B5%D0%BD%D1%81%D0%BA%D0%BE%D0%BC-%D1%8F%D0%B7%D1%8B%D0%BA%D0%B5>

## 1.2 Equality of opportunities and inclusion in education

- Please indicate the actions taken/planned to ensure equality of opportunities (in terms of access, participation and completion), equal treatment and to support the inclusion of all learners in learning processes (*several items may be ticked*):

**General measures:**

- |                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                 |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <input type="checkbox"/> Legislation provides for inclusive education for all                                       | <input type="checkbox"/> Multiple and flexible learning pathways <sup>17</sup> are provided for |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Policy measures aim to enhance inclusion in education for all                              | <input type="checkbox"/> Curricula and teaching methods are inclusive in design <sup>18</sup>   |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Teachers are trained on inclusive education <sup>16</sup> and to value diversity           | <input type="checkbox"/> Multilingual and intercultural education is supported                  |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Initiatives to address discrimination and promote cultural diversity and mutual acceptance |                                                                                                 |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Other:                                                                                     |                                                                                                 |

A training appeared in Ashgabat, which used a speech synthesizer in the Turkmen language for people with an in-depth understanding [HTTPS://TURKMENPORTAL.COM/BLOG/72677/V-ASHHABADE-PROVEDEN-TRENING-PO-ISPOLZOVANIYU-SINTEZATORA-RECHIDLYA-LYUDEI-S-NARUSHENIEM-ZRENIYA](https://turkmenportal.com/blog/72677/v-ashhabade-proveden-trening-po-ispolzovaniyu-sintezatora-rechidlya-lyudei-s-narusheniem-zreniya)  
UNICEF and the Ministry of Education have trained graduates of “Palace of Orphans.” in Ashgabat and the orphanages of Balkanabad in ICT skills  
<https://www.unicef.org/turkmenistan/ru/%D0%9F%D1%80%D0%B5%D1%81%D1%81-%D1%80%D0%B5%D0%BB%D0%B8%D0%B7%D1%8B/%D1%8E%D0%BD%D0%B8%D1%81%D0%B5%D1%84-%D0%B8-%D0%BC%D0%B8%D0%BD%D0%B8%D1%81%D1%82%D0%B5%D1%80%D1%81%D1%82%D0%B2%D0%BE-%D0%BE%D0%B1%D1%80%D0%B0%D0%B7%D0%BE%D0%B2%D0%B0%D0%BD%D0%B8%D1%8F-%D0%BE%D0%B1%D1%83%D1%87%D0%B8%D0%BB%D0%B8-%D0%B2%D1%8B%D0%BF%D1%83%D1%81%D0%BA%D0%BD%D0%B8%D0%BA%D0%BE%D0%B2-%C2%ABd%C3%B6wletliler-k%C3%B6C5%9Fgi%C2%BB-%D0%B2-%D0%B0%D1%88%D1%85%D0%B0%D0%B1%D0%B0%D0%B4%D0%B5-%D0%B8>

- Please elaborate and, where appropriate, indicate the legal and policy measures taken:

- In general, what challenges were encountered in the implementation of non-discrimination and equal opportunities principles in education? If needed, brief quantitative information may be added.

<sup>16</sup> Teachers are prepared to teach all student (beyond just students with disabilities), equipping them with knowledge, values and attitudes that permit every student to succeed. See: [UNESCO policy paper](#): Inclusive teaching: preparing all teachers to teach all students, 2020, p.14.

<sup>17</sup> Multiple and flexible learning pathways are ‘entry points and re-entry points at all ages and all educational levels, strengthened links between formal and non-formal structures, and recognition, validation and accreditation of the knowledge, skills and competencies acquired through nonformal and informal education’ ([Education 2030 Framework for Action](#), para. 33). This may include student transfers between courses and institutions and diverse learning modalities (online, in-person, full-time, part-time, etc.) to respond to individual needs and interests.

<sup>18</sup> In designing the curricula and teaching methods, care is given to ensure that all students are provided with an inclusive and supportive learning experience that offers them the opportunity to succeed whatever their background.

There were no difficulties encountered

### Other relevant general measures, including gender equality

- ☐ Legislation provides for gender equality in education
- ☐ Policy measures aim to enhance gender equality
- ☐ Gender-responsive education sector planning is undertaken
- ☐ Providing positive or affirmative action measures
- ☐ Providing financial incentives and fellowships
- ☐ Teachers are trained (initial and in-service) on gender equality
- ☐ Teachers are trained to combat stigmatisation<sup>19</sup>
- ☐ Other:
- ☐ All barriers for pregnant girls and young mothers in education are eliminated to ensure the continuity of their education
- ☐ Re-entry programmes for young mothers are provided for
- ☐ Ensuring safe and adequate gender-sensitive sanitation facilities<sup>20</sup>
- ☐ Curricula are rid of all stereotypes<sup>21</sup> and bias
- ☐ Ensuring gender parity in science, technology, engineering and mathematics (STEM)
- ☐ Ensuring gender parity in technical and vocational training education and training (TVET)

Against the background of global commitments and within the framework of national policy, Turkmenistan has demonstrated significant progress, confirmed by the 2019 National Voluntary Review, which showed a high level of integration of SDG 4 into the national educational strategy. Progress includes outstanding achievements in the areas of participation in educational processes and literacy, where indicators of 99% have been achieved.

Also, as part of further development, the National Action Plan for Gender Equality for 2021-2025 was adopted, which strengthens the strategic direction for improving gender equality in the educational field, including a number of initiatives aimed at eliminating gender barriers and expanding opportunities for all students, regardless of their gender.

These efforts reflect Turkmenistan's holistic approach to updating the educational system, focusing on international standards and best practices, and underscore the country's commitment to global sustainable development goals.

In addition, significant activities have been implemented within the framework of this National Plan in close cooperation with the United Nations Children's Fund (UNICEF). These efforts not only contribute to strengthening gender equality, but also support the common goal of improving the quality and accessibility of education in Turkmenistan, emphasizing the country's desire to integrate into the international educational and professional space. In order to improve the professional level of teachers in schools on the practical application of improved teaching methods to promote gender equality and prevent gender-based violence, as well as to introduce the principles of a competence-based approach in education into existing

<sup>19</sup> ' Stigmatisation is the act of treating someone or something unfairly by publicly disapproving of them' (Cambridge Dictionary).

<sup>20</sup> ' Gender-sensitive sanitation includes clean, safe and separate toilets, with access to water and garbage disposal' ([UNGEI blog post](#), Gender-sensitive sanitation, 2018)

<sup>21</sup> Stereotype is a set idea that people have about what someone or something is like, especially an idea that is wrong' (Cambridge Dictionary).

curricula, a five-day training was conducted for teachers of secondary schools in Turkmenistan. The training "Seminar on the practical application of improved teaching methods to promote gender equality in secondary schools" was held from October 23 to 27, 2023 at the National Institute of Education of Turkmenistan for 24 school teachers and specialists of the education system of Turkmenistan, which was attended by teachers and representatives of the Education Department of all regions and the city of Ashgabat. This event is part of an effort to turn children's education into a means to strengthen gender equality and inclusivity for future generations.

The seminar was organized as part of the implementation of the National Action Plan for Gender Equality in Turkmenistan for 2021-2025 and contributes to achieving the objectives of Sustainable Development Goals 4.5 and Sustainable Development Goals 4.7. Our goal is to create a gender-oriented learning system taking into account the psychological and age characteristics of students, contributing to improving quality academic performance, harmonious personal development regardless of gender the student and the creation of conditions for maximum self-realization and disclosure of the abilities of boys and girls. In this regard, the relevant and promising topics of this seminar were:

1. Gender-oriented pedagogy and teacher competencies;
2. Gender-oriented education and upbringing: lesson planning, teaching materials (methods of their selection and adaptation) and constructive feedback;
3. The organization of the classroom and the specifics of working in a classroom with a large number of students;
4. Ensuring a safe learning environment: gender conflicts and prevention of gender-based violence;
5. Reproductive health and puberty through a gender-sensitive lens.

Gender education and education is a complex system that includes three main components: the teacher, the family (in particular the parents) and the child himself. And the development of only one of them is not enough for the growth, development and transformation of the entire system of gender education and education. With this in mind, UNICEF, together with the Ministry of Education of Turkmenistan, proposed to hold a seminar for parents in order to promote gender equality not only in schools, but also in families, in particular. The workshop for parents is part of this systemic task, which will provide participants with relevant knowledge, skills and values that will enable them to contribute to the effective implementation of a gender mainstreaming strategy in their family, community and country as a whole. Parents' gender awareness will promote gender equality, namely encouraging open communication, expressing emotions and creating a safe space where all family members can share their feelings without judgment and stereotypes.

The five-day seminar for parents took place from November 21 to 27, 2023, the relevant topics of which were:

1. Gender awareness as a path to gender equality and human rights;
2. Gender roles and society: gender stereotypes, stigmatization and their prevention;
3. Gender difficulties in child-parent relations;

4. Emotional intelligence is the key to building healthy relationships;

5. Create a safe environment (prevention of bullying, gender bias and discrimination) and preserve reproductive health.

As already noted above, gender education and education is a complex system, at the centre of which is the student himself. Therefore, a five-day training was also conducted with students of secondary schools in Turkmenistan, the purpose of which was to fulfil the following task - "Educating young people based on national values, as well as in the spirit of respect for gender equality." This workshop allowed participants to expand their knowledge, skills and values in the field of gender issues, which will further contribute to the creation of a safe gender-learning environment in the classroom and in school as a whole, through building effective relationships with peers that exclude gender stereotypes, discrimination and gender bias, thereby strengthening gender equality both in their classroom, at school, in the community, and in the family. As part of the acquired knowledge, students also began to better understand aspects of their reproductive health, as well as put into practice strategies for its maintenance and development. The seminar aroused great interest among all participants. The students actively shared their thoughts and ideas on the topics of the seminar, talked about the difficulties in building communication with peers and adults, shared their life experiences, worked effectively both in teams and individually, demonstrating their creative abilities and creativity. Below you can get acquainted with the topics of this seminar:

1. Gender awareness as a path to gender equality and human rights;

2. Gender roles and society: gender stereotypes, stigmatization and their prevention;

3. Gender difficulties in child-parent relations;

4. Emotional intelligence is the key to building healthy relationships;

5. Create a safe environment (prevention of bullying, gender bias and discrimination) and preserve reproductive health.

In addition, within the framework of the implemented gender policy of Turkmenistan, the following methodological manuals have been developed and approved:

1. "To teachers about gender-oriented pedagogy". Educational and methodical manual for teachers of educational institutions;

2. "Fundamentals of gender knowledge". Educational and methodical manual for students of educational institutions;

3. "To parents about gender-oriented pedagogy". Educational and methodological guide for parents.

**\*\*July version text is as per below\*\***

*Turkmenistan has demonstrated significant progress in integrating global commitments to sustainable development into national education policies, particularly in the area of gender equality. The 2019 National Voluntary Review showed that the country is successfully implementing the Sustainable Development Goals (SDG 4), achieving high indicators in educational processes and literacy.*



*The implementation of the National Action Plan on Gender Equality 2021–2025 is a key step towards improving access to education for all students, regardless of gender. The plan includes measures to eliminate gender barriers and expand educational opportunities.*

*Collaboration with UNICEF has facilitated the implementation of significant initiatives under this plan. One such initiative was a five-day training for teachers, held from 23 to 27 October 2023. The training aimed to enhance the professional level of teachers in the application of improved teaching methods that promote gender equality and prevent gender-based violence.*

*An important part of the strategy to strengthen gender equality is also parent training. The seminar for parents, held from 21 to 27 November 2023, is aimed at developing gender awareness and forming approaches to gender education at home.*

*Turkmenistan's educational policy also includes educational seminars for students aimed at educating young people in the spirit of national values and gender equality. These activities not only improve the educational environment, but also contribute to the formation of healthy interpersonal relationships among students.*

*Additionally, teaching aids for teachers, students and parents have been developed and approved, which serve as a basis for a deep understanding and practical application of gender-oriented pedagogy.*

*Thus, Turkmenistan is actively working to create an inclusive and fair education system that meets international standards and responds to global challenges of our time. These efforts confirm the country's commitment to achieving the Sustainable Development Goals and strengthening social equality and justice.*

- Please elaborate and, where appropriate, indicate the legal and policy measures taken:

According to the Law of Turkmenistan "On State guarantees of ensuring equal rights and equal opportunities for women and men", the State establishes guarantees for ensuring gender equality in all spheres of State and public life.

In December 2020, the second "National Action Plan for Gender Equality in Turkmenistan for 2021-2025" was approved, developed with the advisory support of the United Nations Population Fund. This document is aimed at ensuring conditions for equal participation of men and women in all spheres of society.

Gender issues are also reflected in the "Framework Program for Cooperation in the field of sustainable development between the United Nations and the Government of Turkmenistan for 2021-2025", "National Action Plan for Human Rights in Turkmenistan for 2021-2025", "National Action Plan for the realization of Children's Rights in Turkmenistan for the period up to 2023-2028". The next one is currently being developed.

- What challenges were encountered in achieving gender equality in and through education? If needed, brief quantitative information may be added.

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- Does the legal minimum age for marriage conform to international standards (18 years) <sup>22</sup>:

*Please note that child marriage is a discriminatory practice as often girls can marry at a younger age than boys. Child marriage violates the child's right to education as they are more likely to drop out of school and children who are not in school are more likely to get married.*

☐ Yes ☐ No

- Please provide reference to the relevant laws and provisions and indicate the exceptions to the legal age of marriage as well as the absolute minimum age:

The Family Code of Turkmenistan, Article 15: The age of marriage is eighteen years old. However, in exceptional cases, the guardianship and custody authorities may, upon the request of individuals wishing to marry, reduce the age of marriage, but not by more than one year.

### **National minorities:**

*For reference: Article/Paragraph 5(1)(c) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the rights of national minorities.*

- |                                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                      |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <input type="checkbox"/> Legislation provides for the right to education of national minorities                                | <input type="checkbox"/> Teachers are trained on intercultural education                                             |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Policy measures aim to enhance the right to education of national minorities                          | <input type="checkbox"/> Teachers are trained to combat stigmatisation <sup>24</sup>                                 |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Policy elaboration includes consultations with local communities                                      | <input type="checkbox"/> Multilingual and intercultural education are supported                                      |
| <input type="checkbox"/> The right to carry out their own educational activities is legally guaranteed for national minorities | <input type="checkbox"/> Native language instruction is ensured for national minorities                              |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Educational standards are established for educational institutions run by national minorities         | <input type="checkbox"/> Adapting curricula and teaching and learning methods to their needs for national minorities |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Positive or affirmative action measures are provided for national minorities                          | <input type="checkbox"/> Curricula are rid of all stereotypes <sup>25</sup> and bias                                 |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Financial incentives and fellowships are provided for national minorities                             |                                                                                                                      |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Other <sup>23</sup> :                                                                                 |                                                                                                                      |

<sup>22</sup> Please note that according to the Joint general recommendation No. 31 of the Committee on the Elimination of Discrimination against Women/general comment No. 18 of the Committee on the Rights of the Child on harmful practice, para. 20: "a marriage of a mature, capable child below 18 years of age may be allowed in exceptional circumstances, provided that the child is at least 16 years of age and that such decisions are made by a judge based on legitimate exceptional grounds defined by law and on the evidence of maturity, without deference to culture and tradition."

<sup>23</sup> Please see: [UNESCO report](#) 'The right to education of minorities: Overview of States' measures reported in the 10th Consultation on the 1960 Convention and Recommendation against Discrimination in Education, 2023.

<sup>24</sup> Supra note 15.

<sup>25</sup> Supra note 16.

- Please elaborate and, where appropriate, indicate the legal and policy measures taken:

On June 12, 2023, a meeting was held in the Parliament of Turkmenistan with a delegation of the Organization for Security and Co-operation in Europe (OSCE) headed by High Commissioner for National Minorities (HCNM) Kairat Abdrakhmanov. During the meeting, the parties discussed issues related to national minorities and their integration into society, and it was also noted that Turkmenistan has ratified the main international conventions, including in the field of human rights. Great attention is paid to the protection and exercise of the rights of all members of society, which is reflected in the National Human Rights Action Plan for 2021-2025. The special importance attached in the country to the issues of deep integration of young people into world science, learning foreign languages, which in turn plays a key role in the development of international cooperation, was emphasized.

On June 13, 2023, a meeting was held between Chairman of the Cabinet of Ministers of Turkmenistan Rashid Meredov and High Commissioner of the Council for National Minorities Kairat Abdrakhmanov. The sphere of education was highlighted as a priority area of cooperation. In this context, an important step was the signing in April 2021 of a Memorandum of Cooperation between the Ministry of Education of Turkmenistan and the Office of the OSCE High Commissioner for National Minorities on cooperation on linguistic and cultural diversity in Turkmenistan.

At the moment, according to the Law of Turkmenistan "On Education" (new edition), citizens of Turkmenistan are guaranteed the opportunity to receive quality education throughout their lives, regardless of nationality, skin color, gender, origin, property and official status, place of residence, language, attitude to religion, political beliefs or other circumstances, as well as age and health conditions.

Also, according to the Law of Turkmenistan "On Education", the state, taking into account the growing global social, environmental and economic interdependence, promotes the mastery of foreign languages by citizens of Turkmenistan, including the official working languages of the United Nations, in educational institutions of all types, regardless of their forms of ownership.

In addition, according to the above-mentioned law, in educational institutions of foreign states or joint ones operating on the territory of Turkmenistan, in accordance with this Law, other normative legal acts and international treaties of Turkmenistan, the main language of instruction is the corresponding foreign language (languages).

In accordance with the Law of Turkmenistan "On Language" dated May 24, 1990, legal guarantees are provided for the free development and use of Turkmen as the state language of Turkmenistan, Russian as a means of interethnic communication, as well as the languages of other people's living in the country. The study of foreign languages is included in general education and professional educational programs as compulsory subjects.

According to statistics, in the 2023-2024 academic year, schools operate in Turkmenistan, where, along with teaching in the state language, they also study in foreign languages, in particular in Russian, Turkish, and some subjects in English.

Russian language schools operate in the country, and Russian and English languages are also studied in all schools as the main discipline.

Currently, Turkmenistan has specialized schools with advanced study of foreign languages such as English, German, French, Italian, Chinese, Japanese, Korean, Farsi, Arabic and Turkish.

There are schools in the country where education is not conducted in the official language. Representatives of ethnic minorities are not prohibited, but are guaranteed the right to use their native language and study their native language.

There are joint schools in the country: Turkmen-Russian and Turkmen-Turkish schools, where education is conducted in Russian, Turkish and English.

In all educational institutions (starting from kindergartens), children of Turkmen, Russian, Uzbek, Armenian, Kazakh and other nationalities, girls and boys, sit at the same desk and study together.

The lack of schools for small ethnic minorities in their language of instruction is due to difficulties in providing them with teaching staff, pedagogical literature, economically low prospects and other factors. Education through the implementation of various educational programs outside of school is not prohibited, educational activities are licensed by the Ministry of Education of Turkmenistan. It should be noted that during the years of the country's independence, there have been no cases of requesting courses on teaching any language of ethnic minorities.

Of particular importance in language learning is the Decree of the President of Turkmenistan dated December 22, 2017, on the basis of which the "Concept of improving foreign language teaching" and an action plan for its implementation were adopted.

At the first stage, in 2018, there was the development of international experience in the field of methodological support, improvement of state standards, relevant curricula and training programs.

At the second stage, in 2019-2020, the system of teacher training and retraining, the educational and methodological base in this area were improved, and monitoring was launched to monitor the effectiveness of the implementation of this Concept.

At the third stage, in 2021-2024, it is planned to create a continuous, consistent and interconnected system of teaching foreign languages.

**\*\*July version text is as per below\*\***

*Meetings between representatives of Turkmenistan and the delegation of the Organization for Security and Cooperation in Europe (OSCE) underline the importance of international cooperation in the field of human rights and integration of national minorities. These discussions highlight Turkmenistan's efforts to improve the living conditions of national minorities and their full participation in public life, which is also part of a broader strategy in the field of human rights and international cooperation.*

*Education as a tool for integration and intercultural dialogue*

*The main focus of cooperation with the OSCE in the field of education underlines Turkmenistan's desire to develop linguistic and cultural diversity. The signing of the Memorandum of Cooperation between the Ministry of Education of Turkmenistan and the Office of the OSCE High Commissioner on National Minorities is an important step in*

*supporting this area. The cooperation is aimed at expanding opportunities for learning the languages of national minorities and strengthening intercultural understanding.*

#### *Integration of national minorities into the educational system*

*Turkmenistan's educational legislation establishes equal opportunities for all citizens, regardless of their ethnicity. This is confirmed by the opportunities for learning foreign languages in schools and the presence of educational institutions where instruction is conducted in various languages, including Russian, Turkish and English. These schools serve as a bridge for integration and the provision of equal educational opportunities.*

#### *Language education and cultural diversity*

*Turkmenistan is actively working to create conditions for learning foreign languages, which is evident from the wide range of language programs in schools. The policy in the field of language education, especially taking into account the Presidential Decree of 2017, is aimed at creating a consistent and interconnected system of teaching foreign languages, which contributes to greater integration of students into the globalized world.*

*Meetings with OSCE representatives highlight Turkmenistan's progress in integrating national minorities and supporting cultural diversity through education. This approach not only strengthens intercultural dialogue but also contributes to a more harmonious development of a society oriented towards international cooperation and respect for diverse cultural and linguistic traditions. At the same time, Turkmenistan is taking active steps to improve its educational policy, focusing on ensuring accessibility and quality of education for all segments of the population, including national minorities. This helps to strengthen social cohesion and enhance the educational potential of the country as a whole.*

*The measures taken in the framework of cooperation with the OSCE emphasize Turkmenistan's strategic orientation toward integration into international educational and cultural processes, which is an important aspect of modern globalization. The introduction of programs aimed at studying foreign languages and cultures not only contributes to a better understanding and interpenetration of cultures, but also prepares the younger generation for active participation in international dialogue and economic cooperation.*

*Support for cultural diversity and educational initiatives aimed at harmonizing interethnic relations is a key factor in ensuring sustainable development and social peace in the country. Turkmenistan, cooperating with international organizations such as the OSCE, demonstrates its openness and desire to build an open and inclusive society.*

*In conclusion, Turkmenistan's efforts to integrate national minorities and promote intercultural education reflect a deep understanding that education and cultural diversity are the foundation for building a just and prosperous society. These steps contribute not only to improving the domestic social situation, but also to strengthening the country's international image as an active participant in the global community.*

- What challenges were encountered in realizing the right to education of minorities? If needed, brief quantitative information may be added.

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**Indigenous people:**

- |                                                                                                                              |                                                                                                                    |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <input type="checkbox"/> Legislation provides for the right to education of indigenous people                                | <input type="checkbox"/> Financial incentives and fellowships are provided for indigenous people                   |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Policy measures aim to enhance the right to education of indigenous people                          | <input type="checkbox"/> Teachers are trained on intercultural education                                           |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Policy elaboration includes consultations with local communities                                    | <input type="checkbox"/> Teachers are trained to combat stigmatisation <sup>26</sup>                               |
| <input type="checkbox"/> The right to carry out their own educational activities is legally guaranteed for indigenous people | <input type="checkbox"/> Multilingual and intercultural education are supported                                    |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Educational standards are established for educational institutions run by indigenous people         | <input type="checkbox"/> Native language instruction is ensured                                                    |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Positive or affirmative action measures are provided for indigenous people                          | <input type="checkbox"/> Adapting curricula and teaching and learning methods to their needs for indigenous people |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Other:                                                                                              | <input type="checkbox"/> Curricula are rid of all stereotypes <sup>27</sup> and bias                               |

- Please elaborate and, where appropriate, indicate the legal and policy measures taken:

- What challenges were encountered in realizing the right to education of indigenous people? If needed, brief quantitative information may be added.

**People on the move (migrants, refugees, asylum-seekers, stateless persons and internally displaced persons) and trapped populations<sup>28</sup>:**

- |                                                                                   |                                                                                             |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <input type="checkbox"/> Legislation provides for their right to education        | <input type="checkbox"/> Financial incentives and fellowships are provided for              |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Policy measures aim to enhance their right to education  | <input type="checkbox"/> Auxiliary assistance is provided                                   |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Inclusion in mainstream schools is ensured               | <input type="checkbox"/> Multiple and flexible learning pathways <sup>31</sup> are provided |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Positive or affirmative action measures are provided for | <input type="checkbox"/> Curricula are rid of all stereotypes <sup>32</sup> and bias        |

<sup>26</sup> Supra note 15.

<sup>27</sup> Supra note 16.

<sup>28</sup> 'Trapped populations are those who are unable to migrate to safe locations and remain trapped in locations vulnerable to the impacts of climate hazards' ([UNESCO report](#): The impact of climate displacement on the right to education, 2020, p. 2).

<sup>31</sup> Supra note 13

<sup>32</sup> Supra note 16.

- ☐ All administrative barriers to access education are removed
- ☐ Accelerated learning programmes are provided
- ☐ Alternative administrative procedures (placement tests, portfolio of evidence, etc.) to overcome administrative barriers<sup>29</sup> are provided for
- ☐ Non-formal and/or alternative education programmes are provided
- ☐ Teachers are specifically trained to ensure their inclusion
- ☐ Language classes to newcomers are provided for
- ☐ Teachers are trained to combat stigmatisation<sup>30</sup>
- ☐ Multilingualism and intercultural education are encouraged
- ☐ Other:

- Please elaborate and, where appropriate, indicate the legal and policy measures taken:

- Have specific measures been adopted for climate displaced persons?

☐ Yes ☐ No

- Please elaborate:

- What challenges were encountered in realizing the right to education of migrants, refugees, asylum seekers, stateless persons and IDPs? If needed, brief quantitative information may be added.

#### **People with disabilities:**

- ☐ Legislation provides for their right to education
- ☐ Mainstream teachers are specifically trained on disabilities
- ☐ Policy measures aim to enhance their right to education
- ☐ Teachers are trained to combat stigmatisation<sup>33</sup>
- ☐ Inclusion in mainstream schools is ensured
- ☐ Auxiliary assistance is provided
- ☐ Special schools are used as resource centers to inclusive schools
- ☐ Curricula and teaching and learning methods are adapted

<sup>29</sup> While lack of documentation (such as identity papers, birth certificates, residency permits, etc.) should not be an obstacle to access education, these can constitute a barrier to education See: [UNESCO publication](#): Handbook on the right to education, 2018, p. 96.

<sup>30</sup> Supra note 15.

<sup>33</sup> Supra note 15.

☐ Positive or affirmative action measures are provided

☐ Financial incentives and fellowships are provided

☐ Other

☐ Curricula are rid of all stereotypes<sup>34</sup> and bias

☐ Education infrastructure and learning materials are adapted

- Please elaborate and, where appropriate, indicate the legal and policy measures taken:

The Constitution of Turkmenistan: <https://minjust.gov.tm/ru/hukuk/merkezi>

The Law of Turkmenistan On Education: <https://minjust.gov.tm/ru/hukuk/merkezi>

<https://www.unicef.org/turkmenistan/ru/%D0%BA%D0%B0%D1%87%D0%B5%D1%81%D1%82%D0%B2%D0%B5%D0%BD%D0%BD%D0%BE%D0%B5-%D0%B8%D0%BD%D0%BA%D0%BB%D1%8E%D0%B7%D0%B8%D0%B2%D0%BD%D0%BE%D0%BE%D0%B1%D1%80%D0%B0%D0%B7%D0%BE%D0%B2%D0%B0%D0%BD%D0%B8%D0%B5>

The State actively cooperates with the UN and its specialized organizations. An example is the cooperation between UNDP and national partners in the field of inclusive education and employment of persons with disabilities within the framework of the seminar "Promotion of vocational education and employment of people with disabilities: international best practices and development of recommendations". The event was organized within the framework of the project "Affordable Work for People with Disabilities in Turkmenistan: Transforming Social Enterprises for educational opportunities and decent work", implemented jointly by UNDP and the Society of the Blind and Deaf of Turkmenistan (OSGT) with financial support from the Fund for Global Development and South-South Cooperation.

**\*\*July version text is as per below\*\***

*Turkmenistan's cooperation with the UN and its agencies, in particular with the UN Development Programme (UNDP), actively contributes to strengthening the national system of inclusive education and support for persons with disabilities. An example of such cooperation is the organization of a seminar on "Promoting vocational education and employment of persons with disabilities: best international practices and development of recommendations." This event, held within the framework of the project "Accessible Work for Persons with Disabilities in Turkmenistan: Transforming Social Enterprises for Education and Decent Work Opportunities," is part of a broader effort to integrate people with special needs into society and the country's economy.*

*Financial support for such initiatives from the Global Development and South-South Cooperation Fund underlines international support aimed at developing inclusive practices in Turkmenistan. These efforts coincide with the global Sustainable Development Goals aimed at ensuring inclusive and equitable quality education and promoting lifelong learning opportunities for all.*

*Projects such as the workshop organised by UNDP and the Society of the Blind and Deaf of Turkmenistan demonstrate the practical application of international experience and developments in the field of education and employment of persons with disabilities, and stimulate the development of policies and programmes that can be adapted to the national*



*context of Turkmenistan to ensure greater social inclusion and economic activity of this category of citizens.*

*Thus, international cooperation aimed at improving the living and working conditions of people with disabilities is a key element of Turkmenistan's social development strategy, which contributes to the creation of an inclusive society in which every person can realize their potential and contribute to the development of the country.*

- What challenges were encountered in realizing the right to education of people with disabilities? If needed, brief quantitative information may be added.

**Students from poor households:**

- |                                                                                                                                        |                                                                                      |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <input type="checkbox"/> Financial incentives and fellowships for school enrolment are provided                                        | <input type="checkbox"/> Teachers are trained to combat stigmatisation <sup>35</sup> |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Transport, meals and education material are subsidised or provided free of charge beyond compulsory education | <input type="checkbox"/> Curricula are rid of all stereotypes <sup>36</sup> and bias |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Positive or affirmative action measures are provided                                                          |                                                                                      |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Other:                                                                                                        |                                                                                      |

- Please elaborate and, where appropriate, indicate the legal and policy measures taken:

- What challenges were encountered in realizing the right to education of students from poor households? If needed, brief quantitative information may be added.

## 2. Progress made with respect to implementing the right to education across all levels and forms of education

### 2.1 Early childhood care and education

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<sup>35</sup> Supra note 15.

<sup>36</sup> Supra note 16.

*For reference: Early childhood care and education (ECCE) is not explicitly provided for in the Convention/Recommendation. However, the international community has increasingly recognized the importance of ECCE over the years. The Committee on the Rights of the Child initially recognized “the right to education during early childhood as beginning at birth” (General Comment No. 7). This became more explicit with the 2010 Moscow Framework for Action and Cooperation<sup>37</sup> and more recently, the Tashkent Declaration and Commitments to Action for Transforming Early Childhood Care and Education<sup>38</sup>. In the current context of the Education 2030 agenda, under SDG target 4.2, states have now committed to “the provision of at least one year of free and compulsory pre-primary education”.*

- Please indicate the measures taken to ensure access to quality ECCE (several items may be ticked):

- |                                                                                       |                                                                                                           |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <input type="checkbox"/> Prior to pre-primary education, ECCE services are free       | <input type="checkbox"/> ECCE services respect a child’s need for early cognitive and social development, |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Prior to pre-primary education, ECCE services are affordable | foundational learning, responsive care,                                                                   |
| <input type="checkbox"/> ECCE services are accessible on a non-discriminatory basis   | nutrition, health, safety, protection, and play.                                                          |

- Please elaborate further on the measures taken:

The implementation of the National Strategy for Early Childhood Development in Turkmenistan for 2020-2025 and the corresponding Program for improving the work of preschool institutions has become an important step in improving the conditions for the upbringing and education of children at the early stages of their development. These initiatives reflect Turkmenistan's commitment to ensuring equal opportunities for the development of all children, regardless of their physical or social conditions. The strategy includes a set of measures aimed at creating an inclusive and supportive environment for children.

Key aspects of the strategy implementation:

1. Updating legislation: All legislative and regulatory acts related to pre-school education have been analyzed and updated, which made it possible to make changes that meet modern requirements for early childhood development.

2. Vocational training: Regular professional development of preschool education workers has become mandatory. This training is conducted on the basis of the National Institute of Education and other educational institutions, which helps to increase the level of professionalism of teachers.

<sup>37</sup> Which states that “ECCE is part of the right to education and the main foundation for holistic human development”.  
<sup>38</sup> Which commits states to “Enhance policy and legal frameworks to ensure that the right to education includes ECCE”

3. Intersectoral cooperation: The strategy actively uses intersectoral approaches, especially in the field of early detection and intervention in child development, which includes health, education and social services.

4. Infrastructural development: Significant investments were made in the creation and equipping of early development centers, including for children with disabilities.

5. Monitoring and evaluation: A system of annual monitoring of children's readiness for school has been introduced, the results of which are used to adapt educational programs and methods.

- Equal access to education: The Strategy promotes the creation of equal conditions for the education of all children, which is important for reducing social inequality.

- Improving health and development: The integration of medical and educational approaches contributes to the better physical and mental development of children.

- Long-term socio-economic benefits\*\*: Investing in early development is seen as a long-term investment in the country's future, as educated and healthy children become productive members of society.

Collaboration with international partners, including UNICEF, plays a key role in the successful implementation of these initiatives, providing the necessary expertise and financial support. The implementation of the National Strategy for Early Childhood Development provides Turkmenistan with the opportunity to become a leader in the region in early childhood education and development, contributing to the achievement of sustainable development goals and creating the foundation for a prosperous future.

**\*\*July version text is as per below\*\***

The main achievement in early childhood development is the implementation of the “National Strategy for Early Childhood Development in Turkmenistan for 2020-2025 ” and “Program for Improving the Work of Preschool Institutions for 2020-2025 for Early Childhood Development and Preparation for School in Turkmenistan” approved by the Decree 06.12.2019 of the President of Turkmenistan No. 1526 of May 2015 and No. 1768 of May 20.05.20202015 , within the framework of which the following was done.

In light of the National Program for Early Childhood Development, all current legislative and legal acts, regulatory and instructional documents related to education were analyzed and appropriate changes and additions were made to them, and new ones were developed and approved.

Issues of early development and preparation of children for school were included in the programs for advanced training of preschool education workers, which are organized on a mandatory regular basis at the National Institute of Education of Turkmenistan, faculties for advanced training of teaching staff at higher pedagogical educational institutions and Centers at the Main Education Departments of the velayats and the city of Ashgabat.

During the implementation of the National Program, including with the support of the UNICEF Representative Office in Turkmenistan, a large number of seminars, trainings, conferences, and consultative meetings of various levels were held, including with the participation of international consultants and experts.

A great deal of work has been done to build the capacity of the Early Development Centers for children with disabilities opened by the UNICEF Representative Office in

Turkmenistan on the basis of existing general preschool institutions No. 138 in Ashgabat and No. 62 in Turkmenabat . These Centers were equipped with co-financing from the Ministry of Education and UNICEF.

In order to implement issues of development and education of children with disabilities, work was started on a pilot basis in such a new direction as early detection of developmental disorders in children and early intervention using all the possibilities of an intersectoral approach.

An annual monitoring of the level of readiness of all children in preparatory groups for school, in accordance with the current programs, norms and standards of preschool education, has been introduced into the practice of preschool institutions. Based on the analysis of its results, a description is compiled for each child to be submitted to the school upon admission to the first grade, which is important information for the primary school teacher.

The overall goal of the Government of Turkmenistan's Strategy on Early Childhood Development (ECD) for 2020-2025 <sup>39</sup>is to ensure that all girls and boys under the age of 7 have the rights to survival, development, protection and inclusion . Supporting children from an early age is essential for their comprehensive development and health and is a long-term investment in maintaining well-being throughout their lives.

The ECD strategy reflects international best practice by aligning early childhood development efforts with the Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) to achieve equitable, prosperous and sustainable growth, and with the five pillars of the International Framework for Care and Nursing – good health, adequate nutrition, responsive care, safety and early learning opportunities.

The implementation of the Strategy will make a significant contribution to the achievement of SDG 4, indicator 4.2 “ensure that all girls and boys have access to quality early childhood development, care and pre-primary education so that they are ready for primary education”, but also to the achievement of other SDGs in the areas of health, education, nutrition, gender, water and sanitation and reducing inequalities.

This strategy is inter-ministerial and recognizes that children's rights to survival and well-being depend on whole-of-government action and systematic contributions from all sectors to improve early childhood development programs, with political and financial support facilitating coordination, effective collaboration and monitoring of joint activities. The Action Plan and Monitoring of the National Strategy for Early Childhood Development in Turkmenistan for 2020-2025 is being implemented in cooperation with the UNICEF Office in Turkmenistan.

- Is compulsory and free of charge pre-primary education available?

☐ Pre-primary education is compulsory. Please provide the age of enrolment and duration:

In educational policy, Turkmenistan closely cooperates with the UNICEF country office, which assists the Government in providing pre-school and primary education services to all children of the country. According to information on its website, primary education coverage in Turkmenistan is high at 97%, and the rates of continuation and completion of education are equally high among boys and girls. UNICEF helps the Government to achieve international standards of quality education, as well as to implement effective education policies, develop the capacity of teachers and specialists of preschool institutions and integrate children with disabilities into the environment of regular education and training. Turkmenistan is making significant efforts to expand the coverage of pre-school education and ensure high-quality preparation of children for primary school. These efforts are aimed at achieving full coverage of preschool education, including very young children and children with disabilities. As part of the strategy for the development of the educational system, Turkmenistan plans to continue

<sup>39</sup>Approved by Decree of the President of Turkmenistan No. I526 dated December 6, 2019

this trend and create all the necessary conditions for full access of all children to preschool education. In accordance with the "Concept of improving the teaching methods of general education programs in Turkmenistan until 2028", it is planned to significantly expand the network of preschool institutions throughout the country. The construction of new schools and kindergartens in all regions of Turkmenistan will make it possible to achieve full coverage of preschool education in the coming years. This also includes creating an inclusive environment that ensures equal access to education for all children, regardless of their characteristics.

**\*\*July version text is as per below\*\***

The state ensures access to preschool institutions for all children residing in the territory of Turkmenistan and having such a right in accordance with the established age. Preparation of preschool children for school is mandatory and is carried out for at least one academic year in preschool, general education or other educational institutions, as well as, as an exception, in the family. Pre-school education covers children from one to six years old.

- ☐ Pre-primary education is **not** compulsory.
- ☐ Pre-primary education is free of charge for all. [Please provide the duration and indicate the extent to which it is free:](#)

This trend will continue, as the expansion of pre-school education coverage is a priority area of state policy in Turkmenistan. This issue is raised in the National Strategy for Early Childhood Development for 2020-2025 and is reflected in the Sustainable Development Goals Program. (4 part 2 subpart). It is important to note that the State is actively working to ensure full coverage of preschool education, which includes preparing children for a successful start of schooling. Currently, there are **1,099 pre-school institutions in Turkmenistan, 6 modern rehabilitation centres (in Ashgabat and in each region), 2 orphanages (which include pre-school departments)**. These figures demonstrate the significant attention paid by the State to the development of the pre-school education system. Within the framework of pilot projects with the support of UNICEF to promote the rights of people with disabilities, within the framework of a joint cooperation program, inclusive education is being implemented in two selected general education preschools and two secondary schools in Ashgabat. International expert Ms. Filomena Pereira assists in initiating the implementation of inclusive education in these institutions during her visit from August 19 to 23. This process is based on the leading role of the education sector with the active involvement of the health and social protection sectors. These programs aim to create a safe and supportive educational environment where all children can learn and develop on an equal basis with their peers. Despite the successes achieved, the coverage of preschool education in Turkmenistan still needs to be expanded. However, the Government is actively working to remedy this situation by continuing to build new schools and kindergartens, introducing inclusive educational practices and ensuring independent monitoring of the quality of education. We are confident that these measures will make it possible to achieve full coverage of preschool education in the coming years, providing high-quality and affordable education for all children.

**\*\*July version text is as per below\*\***

Pre-school education is free for everyone. Children in preschool institutions of all types have the right to receive an education in accordance with state educational standards, to receive additional (including paid) educational services, as well as to free use of textbooks and teaching aids in state educational institutions.

☐ Pre-primary education is **not** free.

- Please list the relevant laws and policies. Where applicable, provide information on the direct costs (e.g., enrolment fees and tuition fees) and indirect costs (e.g., schools supplies, uniforms, transport and compulsory levies on parents). Brief quantitative information may be added.

- What challenges were encountered in realizing early childhood care and education and pre-primary education?

☐ Limited access

☐ Poor learning outcomes

☐ Issues of equity and inclusion

☐ Low number of professionally trained educators

☐ Poor quality programmes

☐ Lack of support to families

☐ Other:

- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.

## 2.2 Primary and secondary education

*For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(a) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for universal primary and secondary education. In the context of the Education 2030 agenda, SDG target 4.1 calls on States to provide “12 years of free, publicly funded, inclusive, equitable, quality primary and secondary education – of which at least nine years are compulsory.”*

### **Primary education**

- Please provide the age of enrolment and duration of primary education:

The Law of Turkmenistan On Education: <https://minjust.gov.tm/ru/hukuk/merkezi>

#### Article 21. Primary education

1. Educational programs at the primary education level are aimed at shaping the student's personality, developing his individual abilities and skills in educational activities, including mastering reading, writing, numeracy, elements of theoretical thinking, basic self-control skills, culture of behavior and speech, the basics of personal hygiene and a healthy lifestyle

2. Primary education is compulsory.

3. Education according to educational programs at the primary education level begins with children who reach the age of six years in the year of admission to a general education institution.

4. The standard period for the development of educational programs at the primary education level is at least four academic years.

5. Primary education can be obtained in one of the following types of general education institutions: general education school, general education boarding school, specialized general education school (indicating the direction of specialized education), general education gymnasium (in-depth study of subjects in the areas of specialized education, introduction to research, creativity, a wide range of additional educational services) and others.

6. At the primary education level, the organization of the educational process on the basis of an integrated approach and responsibility for a group of students (classroom) are assigned to a specific teacher. At the same time, other teaching staff may be involved in conducting training sessions in specialized subjects in the classroom.

7. Primary education is completed with a transfer certification, the positive result of which allows the student to continue studying according to the educational programs of basic secondary education.

- Is primary education compulsory and free of charge?

☐ Primary education is compulsory

☐ Primary education is **not** compulsory.

☐ Primary education is free of charge.

☐ Primary education is **not** free.

- Please list the relevant laws and policies. Where applicable, provide information on the direct costs (e.g., enrolment fees and tuition fees) and indirect costs (e.g., exam fees, schools supplies, uniforms, transport and compulsory levies on parents). Brief quantitative information may be added.

- What challenges were encountered in realizing primary education?

☐ Limited access

☐ Issues of equity and inclusion

☐ High dropout rates

☐ Poor quality programmes

☐ Other:

☐ Poor learning outcomes in:

Foundation literacy

Numeracy

Social and emotional learning

Others

☐ Disparity in learning outcomes

☐ Low number of professionally trained teachers

- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.

|  |
|--|
|  |
|--|

## **Secondary education**

*In this part, please provide information on the general availability and accessibility to all of secondary education, including technical and vocational secondary education and training.*

- Please provide the age of enrolment and duration of lower secondary education:

*The Law of Turkmenistan On Education: <https://minjust.gov.tm/ru/hukuk/merkezi>*

*Article 22. Basic secondary education 1. Educational programs at the level of basic secondary education are aimed at the formation and development of a student's personality by mastering the basics of science, mental and physical labor skills; identifying his inclinations and interests; forming moral beliefs, aesthetic taste and striving for a healthy lifestyle, high culture of interpersonal and interethnic communication.*

*Educational programs at the basic secondary education level are aimed at developing students' abilities for social self-determination and at forming a conscious professional orientation.*

*2. Basic secondary education is compulsory.*

*3. Education in educational programs at the level of basic secondary education begins with children who have primary education.*

*4. The standard period for the development of educational programs at the level of basic secondary education is, as a rule, up to six academic years, while the total duration of education in a general education institution, taking into account primary education, will be up to ten academic years.*

*5. Basic secondary education can be obtained in one of the following types of general education institutions: general education school, general education boarding school, specialized general education school (indicating the direction of specialized education), general education gymnasium (in-depth study of subjects in the areas of specialized education, introduction to research, creativity, a wide range of additional educational services) and others. 6. Educational programs at the basic secondary education level are carried out according to a curriculum focused on specific subjects with an explanation of theoretical concepts on a wide range of issues. Teaching in the classroom is conducted by several teaching staff who have pedagogical training in one or more special subjects.*

*7. Basic secondary education is completed with a transfer certification, the positive result of which allows the student to continue studying in educational programs of full secondary education, taking into account the recommended specialized areas.*

- Please provide the age of enrolment and duration of upper secondary education:

|  |
|--|
|  |
|--|

- Is lower and upper secondary education compulsory and free of charge?

☐ Lower secondary education is compulsory.



- ☐ Lower secondary education is **not** compulsory.
- ☐ Lower secondary education is free of charge.
- ☐ Lower secondary education is **not** free of charge.
- ☒ Upper secondary education is compulsory.
- ☐ Upper secondary education is **not** compulsory.
- ☒ Upper secondary education is free of charge
- ☐ Upper secondary education is **not** free of charge.

- Please list the relevant laws and policies. Where applicable, provide information on the direct costs (e.g., enrolment fees and tuition fees) and indirect costs (e.g., exam fees, schools supplies, uniforms, transport and compulsory levies on parents). Brief quantitative information may be added.

The Law of Turkmenistan On Education: <https://minjust.gov.tm/ru/hukuk/merkezi>

#### Article 23. Complete secondary education

##### 1. Educational programs at the level of full secondary education

They are aimed at the development of cognitive interests and creative abilities of the student; the formation of skills of independent educational activity based on the profile, differentiation and professional orientation of the educational content; preparing the student for life in society, independent life choice and the beginning of work. Educational programs at the level of full secondary education are aimed at specialized and in-depth study of subjects that are more differentiated and provide students with a wider range of opportunities and directions to prepare for the development of professional educational programs.

2. Education in educational programs at the level of full secondary education is carried out in one of the specialized areas specified in Article 24 of this Law, chosen by students on the basis of interests, inclinations and abilities, as well as recommendations of a general education institution based on the results of mastering the educational program at the level of basic secondary education.

Education in educational programs at the level of full secondary

education begins with children who have basic secondary education.

4. Full secondary education is compulsory and can be

received in one of the following types of general education institutions:

general education school, general education boarding school,

specialized general education school (indicating the direction

of specialized education), general education gymnasium (in-depth

study of subjects in the areas of specialized education, introduction to

research, creativity, a wide range of additional educational services) and others.

The standard period for the development of educational programs at the level of full secondary education is two academic years, while the total duration of education in a general education institution, taking into account the levels of primary and basic secondary education, will be up to twelve academic years.

- Please indicate whether the legal minimum age for employment is aligned with the end of compulsory education:

*For reference: The employment laws and those related to compulsory education are interdependent and mutually reinforce each other. If the minimum age of employment is below that of compulsory education, the child is at risk of dropping out of school to work and therefore not completing compulsory education. On the other hand, if compulsory education is lower than the minimum age of employment, once the child has completed compulsory education, the door is open to child exploitation and the violation of labour laws.*

Yes o No o

- Please provide reference to the relevant laws and provisions and indicate how the provision is enforced:

The Labor Code of Turkmenistan, part 1 of Article 23, an employment contract is concluded with a person who has reached the age of eighteen.

- What challenges were encountered in realizing secondary education?

- |                                                         |                                                                        |
|---------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <input type="checkbox"/> Limited access                 | <input type="checkbox"/> Poor learning outcomes                        |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Issues of equity and inclusion | <input type="checkbox"/> Low readiness of primary graduates            |
| <input type="checkbox"/> High dropout rates             | <input type="checkbox"/> Low number of professionally trained teachers |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Poor quality programmes        |                                                                        |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Other:                         |                                                                        |

- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.

## 2.3 Higher education

*For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(a) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for higher education. Ensuring higher education is essential to achieve SDG4, both targets 4.3<sup>40</sup>, and target 4.4<sup>41</sup>. Article 4 of the Convention requires states to make “higher education equally accessible to all on the basis of individual capacity”. Article 13 of the International Covenant on Economic, Social and Cultural Rights (1966) further adds that this should be pursued by “every appropriate means, and in particular by the progressive introduction of free education”. Higher education includes technical and vocational education and training.*

- Please indicate efforts made to ensure that higher education, including technical, vocation education and training, is equally accessible to all on the basis of individual capacity and/or is available free of charge (*several items may be ticked*):

- ☐ Higher education is free of charge
- ☒ Higher education is accessible on the basis of individual capacity (as assessed by reference to relevant qualifications and experience)
- ☐ Higher education is accessible through financial incentives and scholarships
- ☐ Higher education is accessible through positive or affirmative action measures
- ☐ Higher education is accessible through credit transfer system between states
- ☐ Higher education allows for multiple and flexible learning pathways (flexible entry and re-entry, recognition, validation, and accreditation of knowledge and skills acquired through non-formal and informal education).
- ☐ Other:

**The Law on Education of Turkmenistan**

**Article 3. Principles of state policy in the field of education**

The State policy in the field of education is based on the principles of equality of rights of every person in the full realization of his abilities and talent;

- Please list the relevant laws and policies. Where applicable, provide information on the direct costs (e.g., enrolment fees and tuition fees) and indirect costs (e.g., exam fees, university supplies, transport, accommodation). Brief quantitative information may be added.

- What challenges were encountered in realizing higher education?

- ☐ Limited access
- ☐ Issues of equity and inclusion
- ☐ Poor quality programmes
- ☐ Low number of professionally trained professors
- ☐ Insufficient mechanisms to ensure smooth transition from secondary to tertiary

<sup>40</sup> Which calls on states to “ensure equal access for all women and men to affordable and quality technical, vocational and tertiary education, including university”.

<sup>41</sup> Which recommends to “substantially increase the number of youth and adults who have relevant skills, including technical and vocational skills, for employment, decent jobs and entrepreneurship”.

☐ Poor learning outcomes

☐ Other:

- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.

## 2.4 Adult education and alternative learning

*For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(c) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for adult education and alternative learning. While SDG4 aims to “ensure inclusive and equitable quality education and promote lifelong learning opportunities for all”, target 4.6 specifically calls on states to “ensure that all youth and a substantial proportion of adults, both men and women, achieve literacy and numeracy”. Furthermore, under target 4.4, states are called “to increase and diversify learning opportunities, using a wide range of education and training modalities, so that all youth and adults, especially girls and women, can acquire relevant knowledge, skills and competencies for decent work and life.”*

- Please indicate the measures taken to establish a system of continuing education and equitable access to learning and training opportunities (*several items may be ticked*):

☐ Provision of education for persons who have not received or completed the whole period of their primary education

☐ Provision of literacy programmes

☐ Provision of continuous learning (such as learning programmes to develop knowledge, skills, abilities, or competencies for personal and professional development)

☐ Provision of free of charge learning opportunities

☐ Provision of professional training including reskilling and upskilling programmes

☐ Recognition, validation and certification of non-formal and informal learning

☐ Provision of free of charge career guidance and counselling

☐ Lifelong learning entitlements including learning accounts, vouchers, etc.

☐ Other:

- Please elaborate further on the measures taken:

- What challenges were encountered in realizing adult learning and education?

- |                                                         |                                                                         |
|---------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <input type="checkbox"/> Limited access                 | <input type="checkbox"/> Limited funding                                |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Issues of equity and inclusion | <input type="checkbox"/> Poor learning outcomes                         |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Poor quality programmes        | <input type="checkbox"/> Low number of professionally trained educators |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Other:                         |                                                                         |

- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.

### 3. Quality education provision and learning environment

*For reference: Articles/Paragraphs 2, 4(b) and 5(b) of the Convention/Recommendation provide for quality education. Quality education is fundamental to achieve all targets of SDG4. It is also particularly highlighted in SDG target 4.a that recommends states to “build and upgrade education facilities that are child, disability and gender sensitive and provide safe, non-violent, inclusive and effective learning environments for all”.*

#### 3.1 General measures

- Please indicate whether the legal or regulatory framework lays out the conditions and minimum education standards for the establishment and functioning of public education institutions regarding:

- ☐ State monitoring and inspections
- ☐ Health and sanitation
- ☐ Safety (children learn in a safe environment free from violence or harassment, including school-related gender-based violence (in and around schools))
- ☐ Infrastructure
- ☐ Curriculum
- ☐ Student-teacher ratio
- ☐ School fees (if relevant)
- ☐ Other

- Please elaborate on each of the measures taken:

*You may include information on policies, protocols or codes of conduct.*

The Constitution of Turkmenistan: <https://minjust.gov.tm/ru/hukuk/merkezi>

The Law of Turkmenistan On Education: <https://minjust.gov.tm/ru/hukuk/merkezi>

- What challenges were encountered in realizing quality education?

- |                                                                             |                                                                               |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <input type="checkbox"/> Non-supportive or inadequate learning environments | <input type="checkbox"/> Low quality educational infrastructure and materials |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Violence in schools                                | <input type="checkbox"/> Inadequate parental support to education             |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Cost of education                                  | <input type="checkbox"/> Long distances to schools                            |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Conflicts or crises                                |                                                                               |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Other:                                             |                                                                               |

- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.

### 3.2 Education personnel

*For reference: Article/Paragraph 4(d) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the education personnel. This corresponds to SDG target 4.c which is entirely devoted to the teaching profession as it calls on states to “substantially increase the supply of qualified teachers”.*

- Please indicate the measures taken to improve the teaching and working conditions of education personnel, especially teaching staff at all levels and regarding the training for the teaching profession (several items may be ticked):

- ☐ Teacher training is provided without discrimination.
- ☐ Teachers’ average salaries are competitive or at least comparable to those paid in other professions requiring similar or equivalent qualifications (at all levels).
- ☐ Initial training and continuous professional development are provided.
- ☐ Minimum standards and qualifications required for the teaching profession.
- ☐ Measures taken to strengthen the social status and attractiveness of the teaching profession.
- ☐ Measures taken to promote diversity in the teaching workforce, including to redress gender imbalances at different levels of education.
- ☐ Establishment of performance monitoring systems.
- ☐ Measures taken to increase women in leadership positions in education.
- ☐ Other:

- Please elaborate on each of the measures taken:

The Constitution of Turkmenistan: <https://minjust.gov.tm/ru/hukuk/merkezi>

The Law of Turkmenistan On Education: <https://minjust.gov.tm/ru/hukuk/merkezi>

- What challenges were encountered in the education personnel?

- |                                                                                  |                                                                               |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <input type="checkbox"/> Shortages of teaching staff                             | <input type="checkbox"/> Low quality educational infrastructure and materials |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Lack of qualified, trained and motivated teaching staff | <input type="checkbox"/> High student – teacher ratio                         |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Lack of training centres                                |                                                                               |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Other:                                                  |                                                                               |

- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.

### 3.3 Respect for human rights and fundamental freedoms

*For reference: Article/Paragraph 5(1)(a) of the Convention/Recommendation provides for the respect for human rights and fundamental freedoms. This is covered under SDG target 4.7.<sup>42</sup> Please note that this section contributes to the general monitoring of Article/Paragraph 5(1)(a) of the Convention/Recommendation and that the future consultation on the 1974 Recommendation concerning Education for International Understanding, Co-operation and Peace and Education relating to Human Rights and Fundamental Freedoms // 2023 Recommendation on [...] will be used specifically for monitoring SDG4 indicator 4.7.1.*

- Please indicate the national efforts taken in directing education to the full development of the human personality and the strengthening of respect for human rights and fundamental freedoms (several items may be ticked):

- ☐ Curriculum includes human rights education.
- ☐ Educational and/or extracurricular activities are organized on human rights education.
- ☐ Other:

- Please elaborate on each of the measures taken:

<https://turkmenistan.gov.tm/ru/post/74128/v-letnih-lageryah-turkmenistana-provedeny-lekcii-o-pravah-cheloveka>

<sup>42</sup>

Which calls on states to “ensure that all learners acquire the knowledge and skills needed to promote sustainable development, including, among others, through education for sustainable development and sustainable lifestyles, human rights, gender equality, promotion of a culture of peace and non-violence, global citizenship and appreciation of cultural diversity and of culture’s contribution to sustainable development”.

### 3.4 Non-state actors in education

*For reference: Articles/Paragraphs 2(c) and 5(1)(b) of the Convention/Recommendation provide for non-state education provision<sup>43</sup>.*

- Please indicate the measures taken to ensure the provision of quality non-state education (several items may be ticked):

☐ Legal provisions prohibiting discrimination on the grounds listed by the Convention/Recommendation<sup>44</sup> explicitly apply to non-state educational institutions. Please specify:

The Law of Turkmenistan On Education, Part 1, Article 4. Citizens of Turkmenistan are guaranteed the opportunity to receive education regardless of nationality, skin colour, gender, origin, property and official status, place of residence, language, attitude to religion, political beliefs or other circumstances, as well as age and health status.

The provision of high-quality non-governmental education is controlled by licensing education.

The Law of Turkmenistan On Education: <https://minjust.gov.tm/ru/hukuk/merkezi>

A state educational institution, if it has an appropriate license, has the right to provide other paid educational services to the population, enterprises, institutions and organizations. State institutions that implement educational programs for extracurricular and additional education of students have the right to implement them on a fee basis. The income from the paid activities of a state educational institution specified in parts one, two and three of this article is used by it in accordance with its statutory purposes. Paid educational services cannot be provided instead of educational activities funded from the State Budget of Turkmenistan. Funds earned in violation of this norm are withdrawn to the State Budget of Turkmenistan.

☐ Policies aim to guarantee that the development of non-state education does not generate discrimination and that non-state actors offer a relevant alternative (without supplanting public education). Please specify:

The Constitution of Turkmenistan: <https://minjust.gov.tm/ru/hukuk/merkezi>

The Law of Turkmenistan On Education: <https://minjust.gov.tm/ru/hukuk/merkezi>

☐ Legal provisions provide for the rights of the parents /legal guardians for providing religious and moral education for their children. Please specify:

The Constitution of Turkmenistan: <https://minjust.gov.tm/ru/hukuk/merkezi>

The Law of Turkmenistan On Education: <https://minjust.gov.tm/ru/hukuk/merkezi>

The Family Code of Turkmenistan: <https://minjust.gov.tm/ru/hukuk/merkezi>

<sup>43</sup> Private, faith-based, NGOs, community actors.

<sup>44</sup> See: Article/Paragraph 1(1).



☐ Legal or regulatory framework lays out the conditions and minimum education standards for the establishment and functioning of non-state educational institutions. [Please specify what is covered:](#)

☐ Registration

☐ State monitoring and inspections

☐ Qualifications of teachers

☐ Health and sanitation

☐ Safety (children learn in a safe environment free from violence or harassment, including school-related gender-based violence (in and around schools))

☐ Infrastructure

☐ Curriculum

☐ Student-teacher ratio

☐ School fees

☐ School closures

☐ Other

- Please elaborate:

- What challenges were encountered in non-state education provision?

☐ Low quality educational infrastructure and materials

☐ Issues in terms of equity and inclusion

☐ Low number of professionally trained teachers

☐ Weak government regulatory and monitoring capacity

☐ High student – teacher ratio

☐ Other:

- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.

### 3.5 Digital education

*Digital education is both an opportunity for enhancing access but also can lead to challenges in terms of quality education and inclusion<sup>45</sup>.*

<sup>45</sup>

Please see General Comment No. 25 (2021) of the Committee on the Rights of the Child which covers children's right to education in relation to the digital environment.

- Please indicate the measures taken to ensure the provision of quality digital education (several items may be ticked):

☐ Digital technology use in education is provided for in the legal framework.

Please indicate the relevant text and provisions:

The Law of Turkmenistan On Education: <https://minjust.gov.tm/ru/hukuk/merkezi>

The national concept for the development of the digital educational system has been approved

Over the past five years, significant steps have been taken in Turkmenistan to reduce the digital gender gap, which is an important part of national efforts to strengthen the social and economic status of women. In 2023, the Launch Life Coding Bootcamp project was initiated, a free educational program for women and girls supported by the U.S. Embassy in Turkmenistan. This initiative helped the participants not only improve their digital skills by developing websites and mobile applications, but also promoted their employment in the IT sector, which significantly strengthened their economic position.

Additionally, the DigiWomen STRIVE hackathon, organized by UNDP and the U.S. Embassy, provided women with a platform to work together on technology projects, highlighting their role in digital innovation and entrepreneurship. This event not only supported the development of the technical skills of the participants, but also contributed to their involvement in creating solutions to pressing social issues such as gender equality.

The TechWomen program actively includes Turkmen women in the global community of science and technology professionals, providing them with access to international mentoring and resources, which expands their professional horizons and career opportunities.

In addition, a significant number of women and girls participate in IT courses conducted by the Information Innovation Center and the Turkmen-Indian Information Technology Center, which indicates the country's desire to increase the level of computer literacy among the female population. This, in turn, contributes to strengthening the role of women in the development of the digital economy of Turkmenistan.

As part of the United States' "TechGirls" educational program, students from our country's secondary schools were sent to participate in a program held at Virginia Tech University in Blacksburg, Virginia, from July 13 to August 5, 2024. The program aimed to inspire 15-17-year-old female students to pursue higher education and careers in science, technology, engineering, and mathematics (STEM).

Thus, the measures taken not only reduce the gender digital gap, but also contribute to the broader social and economic inclusion of women in Turkmenistan, confirming the country's strategic vision for gender equality and digital inclusion. The development of digital education is a key strategic direction, confirmed by the Concept of Digital Education Development in Turkmenistan for 2017-2025, approved by presidential decree.

This Concept covers comprehensive measures, including the development of the legislative framework, the creation of e-learning systems, the development of infrastructure and the strengthening of human resources. The implementation of these areas has already yielded tangible results, such as updating educational laws to integrate digital learning methods,

creating an expert council on digitalization of education, launching e-learning platforms and developing numerous educational portals and electronic libraries.

Special attention is paid to the introduction of new disciplines related to digital technologies and the creation of specialized faculties and departments in educational institutions. This not only deepens students' professional knowledge in the field of IT, but also contributes to their integration into the global professional and academic community.

The Ministry of Education of Turkmenistan also actively cooperates with international organizations and participates in global educational projects, which facilitates the exchange of experience and attracting external investments for the further development of digital education. These actions strengthen Turkmenistan's position as a country actively developing its educational infrastructure in accordance with international standards and the UN Sustainable Development Goals.

Within the framework of the "Concept of improving the teaching methods of general education programs in Turkmenistan until 2028", approved by presidential decree, the Government of Turkmenistan seeks to significantly improve the quality of education and raise the status of teachers. The main areas of modernization include the revision of school curricula with an emphasis on digital technologies and STEM education, as well as the integration of international standards such as PISA, TIMSS and PIRLS.

The concept pays attention to the professional development of teachers through the introduction of modern teaching methods and advanced training courses, which helps to strengthen their status and improve working conditions. Emphasis is also placed on the creation and updating of educational materials, including electronic textbooks and resources, which will facilitate access to high-quality educational materials.

Additionally, within the framework of the Presidential Program of Socio-Economic Development for 2022-2028, Turkmenistan is actively integrating digital technologies, environmental and entrepreneurial education into the educational process, supporting sustainable development and vocational education that meets international standards.

The Memorandum of Understanding between the Ministry of Education of Turkmenistan and UNDP provides important benefits for the education system, including promoting innovation, developing distance education, improving educational programs and supporting Turkmenistan's participation in global initiatives. These measures are aimed at creating a modern and competitive educational system in the country.

Teachers and specialists of higher educational institutions actively participate in advanced training courses on such topics as "AR/VR technologies", "Cybersecurity", "Fundamentals of the digital Economy", "Fundamentals of Pedagogy and Psychology", "Automation of the educational process", organized by the Center for Innovative Information of the Ministry of Education, as well as in online courses advanced training in information technology, organized by UNESCO and other organizations, and receive appropriate certificates.

Teachers of general education, secondary vocational and higher educational institutions are provided with methodological recommendations and advice on enriching the lessons of modern computer technology, as well as on improving curricula in accordance with the requirements of the time. Seminars and classes on artificial intelligence, augmented and virtual reality, and big data are held.

The Ministry of Education of Turkmenistan has developed a "Roadmap for the training of highly qualified specialists in the field of cybersecurity in our country."

In order to disseminate the best practices of educational institutions and international practices in digital education, digital economy and cybersecurity, online consultations are regularly held for teachers, staff and responsible IT specialists of higher and secondary vocational educational institutions of our country.

Teachers and specialists of higher educational institutions improve their qualifications in reputable foreign educational institutions within the framework of international cooperation.

The "Plan for training specialists with higher education and improving their skills in the field of cybersecurity for 2024-2026" has been approved.

Within the framework of the Roadmap for the training of highly qualified specialists in the field of cybersecurity in our country for 2023-2024, a list of international events and a list of educational institutions and organizations of advanced countries in the field of cybersecurity have been developed in order to enhance the participation of teachers in advanced training and in scientific and practical conferences, forums, seminars and online courses held leading foreign universities.

The Turkmen Institute of Telecommunications and Informatics organizes online consultations and training sessions with foreign teachers at the cybersecurity laboratory, established jointly with the European Security Agency.

The Center for Innovative Information, in cooperation with the Center for Information Accessibility of the Republic of Korea, organized online courses on cybersecurity for teachers and specialists of educational institutions.

❑ Core legislations, policies, strategies or plans for the management, privacy, security, storage, transfer, use, and sharing of education data internally and externally to ensure the right to privacy of learners and education stakeholders (e.g., informed consent, transparent usage policies, etc.)

❑ Regulatory framework establishes minimum education standards for digital education to which all actors in education must comply.

❑ Measures to remove barriers to accessing digital content<sup>46</sup>, including ensuring access to curriculum-aligned digital content available on free, public, multi-modal national platforms; high-quality content is available in core subjects, official national language(s), and designed with inclusive features to assist learners with disabilities.

❑ Digital skills incorporated into pre- and in-service teacher and leadership training curricula to create a culture of digital innovation and growth anchored in equity and inclusion that enables ongoing professional development for existing and emerging staff.

❑ Future-ready skills (including digital skills, data and AI competencies, critical thinking, etc.) integrated into formal curriculum at all levels of education

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<sup>46</sup> Lack of internet connection, basic infrastructure or devices.

☐ Measures address the digital divide, including ensuring access to reliable electricity, meaningful internet connectivity at school and at home, devices suitable for learning and teaching, safe and sustainable software and secure platforms, and integrated education data systems.

☐ A well-established, sustainable, and cost-effective budget secured from a range of funding sources and intersectoral cooperation, supported by impact focused reporting linked to regional strategic goals.

- Please elaborate on each of the measures taken:

- What challenges were encountered in digital education provision (check all that apply)?

- |                                                                                                                                                          |                                                                                                                           |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <input type="checkbox"/> Lack of quality, curriculum-aligned digital teaching and learning content that supports flexible learning and teaching pathways | <input type="checkbox"/> Limited access to internet and/or electricity                                                    |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Lack of equity and inclusion in digital learning solutions                                                                      | <input type="checkbox"/> Limited access to hardware (devices, chargers, etc.)                                             |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Inadequate safety measures and IT support to respond to issues of child online safety or reduce cyber security risks            | <input type="checkbox"/> Difficulty in regulating the use of digital education solutions                                  |
| <input type="checkbox"/> Other:                                                                                                                          | <input type="checkbox"/> Difficulty in sustainably financing digital education solutions at national scale                |
|                                                                                                                                                          | <input type="checkbox"/> Lack of digital skills development for meaningful use of digital technology in teaching practice |
|                                                                                                                                                          | <input type="checkbox"/> Disjointed or fragmented solutions that are not centrally systematized or regulated              |

- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.

#### 4 Strengthening governance systems

*For reference: The Education 2030 Framework for Action states "to ensure quality education and conditions for effective education outcomes, governments should strengthen education systems by instituting and improving appropriate, effective and inclusive governance and accountability mechanisms; quality assurance; management information systems; transparent and effective financing procedures and mechanisms; and institutional management arrangements, as well as ensure that robust, timely and accessible data are available" (para. 18).*

- Please indicate the measures taken in terms of governance (several items may be ticked):

☐ Monitoring mechanisms to assess compliance with the right to education obligations, including through management information systems.

☐ Monitoring results are made public. Please provide the link:

<https://turkmenistan.gov.tm/ru/post/64380/cifrovoe-upravlenie-v-sfere-obrazovaniya>

<https://orient.tm/ru/post/57579/turkmenistan-i-yunesko-obsudili-sozdanie-informacionnoj-sistemyupravleniya-obrazovaniem>

☐ Monitoring processes are participatory, inclusive and regular.

☐ Sector-wide and multisector approach is adopted to education governance.

☐ Financial resources are effectively allocated to prioritise the provision of free, quality, public education and are adequately budgeted for in government plans.

☐ The decision-making process for the allocation of resources to education is transparent.

☐ Ensuring crisis-sensitive and disaster risk-informed planning and programming, including the provision of quality education in emergencies.

☐ There is a certain degree of decentralization in favour of local public authorities and autonomy for schools to ensure context relevance of their teaching.

- Please elaborate on each of the measures taken:

- What challenges were encountered in terms of governance?

☐ Budgetary constraints

☐ Lack of involvement of relevant stakeholders and lack of cooperation/coordination at different levels

☐ Poor dialogue with teachers' trade unions

☐ Other:

☐ Absence of supportive/ inconsistent/obsolete legal and policy environment

☐ Lack or weakness of monitoring systems – including the lack of reliable data

- Please elaborate. Brief quantitative information may be added.

### III. Methods used to draw the attention of the various authorities in the country to the instruments

*For reference: UNESCO governing bodies have underlined the need for awareness raising. Given the importance of normative action at the national level, wide dissemination of the Convention must be ensured, with the support of National Commissions for UNESCO.*

- Have activities been carried out to draw the attention of the various authorities of the country to the Convention/Recommendation and their provisions about the right to education and to raise awareness of the principles of non-discrimination and equality of educational opportunities? (Several items may be ticked)

☐ Translation of the Convention/Recommendation into the national and possibly local languages

☐ Dissemination and advocacy of the core content of the Convention/Recommendation or the core principles of the right to education including through appropriate materials and resources

☐ Activities undertaken or supported by the National Commission to promote non-discrimination and equality of educational opportunities and to foster debate on critical issues in relation to the rights enshrined in the instruments

☐ Other:

A collection of "Basic international human Rights treaties" has been published in the Turkmen language in paper and electronic versions, which have been distributed to the country's libraries and resource centers. <https://instsld.gov.tm/nesirler/kitaplar/> As part of the implementation of the National Action Plan on Gender, a collection of international legal documents and legislative acts of Turkmenistan "Women's Rights in Turkmenistan" in Turkmen and Russian has been prepared and published. <https://instsld.gov.tm/nesirler/kitaplar/>